



WEDNESDAY
JULY 1, 2026
MUHARRAM 16, 1448

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DUBAI

BY ZAINAB HUSAIN
Features Writer

Shortly after dawn yesterday morning, as the first Etihad Rail passenger train rolled out of the Fujairah station, hundreds of eager passengers etched their name in history.

Arriving in Abu Dhabi at 7.19am, the passengers were the first to experience the future of transportation in the UAE: swift, efficient and green.

Over the course of the day, a total of six passenger services ferried passengers between the two stations, with thousands more set to experience the journey over the coming days.

Customer demand has been strong since bookings opened, with more than 10,000 tickets sold ahead of the start of operations.

“Since the establishment of the Union, connecting people with places has been a fundamental objective of our development journey. Today, Etihad Rail’s passenger service embodies that vision by linking the nation’s cities, reducing travel times and enhancing opportunities for growth and development,” Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court, said in a post on X.

“With the inaugural passenger journey setting off today... we celebrate another national achievement that adds to the UAE’s march towards the future and reflects its ambition to build world-class infrastructure that connects the nation and supports its prosperity,” he added.

Dubai next in line

The Fujairah-Abu Dhabi route is only the first phase of the operations. On September 30, the Dubai station will become operational, while the Sharjah station

NEXT STOP DUBAI

Abu Dhabi-Fujairah train rolls into service amid high demand



Afra Alnofeili/ Gulf News

■ The first Etihad Rail passenger train rolled out of the Fujairah station and arrived in Abu Dhabi yesterday morning.

will become active from March 30 next year.

Dubai’s only Etihad Rail station will be located at Jumeirah Golf Estates, a luxury gated community in the southern part of the city. The station is positioned along Sheikh Mohammed Bin Zayed Road, offering easy road

access for travellers, and is only 30 minutes away from the Al Maktoum International Airport.

Another key advantage is its proximity to the Dubai Metro, allowing passengers to transfer seamlessly into Dubai’s inner-city public transport network.

To deliver a seamless end-to-

end customer journey, Etihad Rail has also announced that it is working closely with the Integrated Transport Centre (Abu Dhabi Mobility) to integrate passenger rail with Abu Dhabi’s wider public transport network, enabling customers to connect easily with buses, taxis and other

mobility services as part of a fully-integrated mobility ecosystem.

Two beginnings

“Every great piece of national infrastructure has two beginnings: the day it is built, and the day people begin making it their own. Today, with the support

and guidance of our wise leadership, we embark on that second beginning. Years from now, today’s passengers will be able to say they were there at the very beginning,” said Azza Alsuwaidi, chief operating officer at Etihad Rail.

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BY MARK THOMPSON
Editor-in-Chief

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Hamdan reviews progress of new education initiatives

Says UAE has made investment in people a deeply-rooted and enduring approach

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of The Executive Council of Dubai, met with Dubai’s Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA) team at Emirates Towers, where he reviewed the progress of new education initiatives being led by the Authority and their implementation plans under Dubai’s Education 33 Strategy.

During the meeting, Sheikh Hamdan affirmed that the UAE has made investment in people a deeply-rooted and enduring approach, supported by the guidance of its leadership.

He added that Dubai continues to strengthen an integrated education system that reflects the UAE’s authentic values and prepares talent capable of safeguarding national achievements while enhancing the emirate’s leadership and competitiveness across sectors.

This is being achieved through high-quality, future-focused education that prioritises the development of skills and talent, helping to prepare a generation that is academically accomplished, firmly rooted in its identity, proud of its language and nation, and capable of excelling on the global stage.

Exceptional learners

Sheikh Hamdan said: “We want every learner in Dubai to be as exceptional as their nation, distinguished by qualities and skills rooted in a strong Emirati identity, authentic values, and noble principles instilled by our Founding Fathers to empower the people of the UAE with knowledge and strengthen their readiness for the future. Our goal will always be to build a generation equipped with life skills and everything needed to lead the future, enabling them to make a positive impact that serves their community and their nation.”

The KHDA team outlined the objectives of key initiatives on this year’s agenda, which focus on strengthening Arabic language learning, enhancing student wellbeing, and equipping learners with life and future skills. The strategy focuses on designing a personalised learning journey for every learner in Dubai.

Bigger savings: Fuel prices for July slashed

First cut brings relief in UAE after four months of steep fuel price rises

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

UAE motorists will pay significantly less to fill up from today after authorities announced the first reduction in fuel prices since the Middle East conflict sent global oil markets soaring four months ago.

The UAE Fuel Price Committee cut prices across all fuel grades for July, reflecting the sharp decline in global oil prices through June as shipping through the Strait of Hormuz started to recover and fears of prolonged supply disruptions eased considerably.

The reductions are among the biggest month-on-month cuts since the UAE adopted market-linked fuel pricing in 2015. The latest reduction will immediately lower fuel bills for commuters and families travelling during the summer.

For a typical 60-litre sedan using Super 98:

■ June: about Dh237

FUEL PRICES JULY 2026	
SUPER 98 PETROL	
JULY:	Dh3.40 per litre
JUNE:	Dh3.95 per litre
SPECIAL 95 PETROL	
JULY:	Dh3.29 per litre
JUNE:	Dh3.83 per litre
E-PLUS 91 PETROL	
JULY:	Dh3.21 per litre
JUNE:	Dh3.76 per litre
DIESEL	
JULY:	Dh3.60 per litre
JUNE:	Dh4.33 per litre

Prices includes 5% VAT

■ July: about Dh204
■ Saving: around Dh33 per tank

For an 80-litre SUV or 4x4:
■ June: about Dh316
■ July: about Dh272
■ Saving: around Dh44 every time drivers fill up.

Before the conflict began, Super 98 cost Dh2.45 in February, while Special 95 was Dh2.34 and E-Plus was Dh2.26. The July revision follows a dramatic turnaround in global oil markets. Brent crude averaged around \$106 a barrel in May, when conflict in the Gulf and disruptions to shipping through the Strait of Hormuz pushed oil prices briefly above \$110-\$120.

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NATION

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